



ILLUSTRATION: Mahesh Benkar

STORE MORE!

A cornucopia of information stored on something the size of a sugar cube or a postage stamp...brace yourself to be enveloped in all the digital information you could ever dream of accessing!

Each time you watch a fast-paced DVD movie or pull down a piece of information from the Internet or even access the ATM at the corner of your street, you are actually tapping into large repositories of digital information. The ability to store large amounts of digital information has brought about the various comforts and possibilities that we are so used to—ready access to any kind of information, portable entertainment devices that fit in the palm of your hands, blazing fast

portable computers, data farms for enterprises and movie experiences that can challenge reality itself.

How big is big?

The rate of advancement in storage technology has been truly amazing. From the first instance of digital storage with IBM's 5 MB RAMAC hard disk drive invented in 1956, all the way to the mammoth 180 GB hard disk drives available today, there has been a 36,000-fold increase

(yes thirty-six thousand!) in storage capacities over the last 50-odd years.

However, we are fast approaching the physical limit for storing information on media such as the magnetic platters of hard disks or the chemical layers in optical devices such as CDs and DVDs. With the promise of tomorrow's operating systems incorporating stunning graphical interfaces that offer truly immersive virtual reality and next generation games that will blur the line between fiction and reality, the

